KEEPING IT REAL

STOP TRASHING THE OTHER AGENT.

NAR has a rule for that, and it has teeth.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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MOST AGENTS THINK VENTING ABOUT THE OTHER SIDE OF A DEAL IS HARMLESS. IT'S A REPORTABLE ETHICS COMPLAINT WAITING TO HAPPEN.

Not a vibe. A specific rule, with specific language.

03 / 05

IT'S NOT VENTING. IT'S A RULE WITH YOUR NAME ON IT.

NAR's Code of Ethics Article 15 says REALTORS shall not knowingly or recklessly make false or misleading statements about other real estate professionals, their businesses, or their business practices. Standard of Practice 15-2 extends that to repeating someone else's false statement, in person, in writing, or online. SOP 15-3 adds a duty to correct or take down a false statement on any electronic media you control once you know it's false. "That agent's impossible to work with" or "the seller's lying about the repairs" said to your own client, with nothing behind it, is the exact conduct the article exists to stop.

SAY THIS INSTEAD:

1. **Describe the behavior, not the person.**
   "They haven't responded to our last two emails" beats

2. **Name what you don't know as what you don't know.**
   "I'm not sure why they've gone quiet, but

3. **Keep a guess about the seller's state of mind out of your client's head.**
   A fact you can

4. **Put the frustrated version in a text to your broker, not your client.**
   Vent somewhere it

"that agent's useless." here's what we're doing about it" beats guessing at a motive out loud. prove is fine to share. A story about why you think they're acting that way is not. doesn't become a record of what you told your buyer.

THE TAKEAWAY

BEFORE YOUR NEXT FRUSTRATED TEXT ABOUT THE OTHER AGENT, READ IT LIKE NÁR WOULD.

If you couldn't prove it in front of an ethics panel, don't send it to your client.

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